

1 Inside the engine

The car's engine is a complicated system of moving parts. These parts work together to spin a long metal rod called a crankshaft, which is connected to the gearbox.

2 In gear

The gearbox is made up of turning cogwheels (called gears), which control the speed of the car's wheels. The wheels push hard and turn slowly when the car is going uphill, but on flat roads they need less force, so the gearbox makes them turn faster.

3 Turning the wheels:

A second set of gears connects the gearbox to a rod called the drive shaft. The gears turn the drive shaft, which turns the car's front wheels.

4

... Spinning around

The car's wheels then turn at the right speed.

